

level payment plan to a graduated one, which allowed him to pay less at first and have his payments gradually increase over time. He was counting on the belief that his salary would also increase with time.

- Utilities—by splitting the electric, phone, and cable TV bills between four roommates, each paid a smaller percentage of the set fees.
- Groceries—by deciding to cook more often and go out to eat only two times a week, he cut down on his food costs.
- Dry cleaning—by ironing his clothes after wearing them, he didn't have to dry clean as often.
- Transportation—by taking the metro instead of taxis.

These reductions were enough to enable Reginald to move out. He knew that he would have to be disciplined, but he was willing to make these sacrifices. An added bonus to his move was that his relationship with his parents improved. As he started viewing himself more as an adult, Reginald found his parents began to treat him accordingly.

Murphy's Law

Major life events are not calculated into our normal day-to-day cost of living. Since we don't have a crystal ball, most life events are surprises. Funding an emergency savings account to handle extra expenses may not have been a priority and you may find yourself unable to handle the expense. As a consequence, life events can lead to moving back in with your parents.

If you think that life events don't or won't happen, look at the following list and identify those that have already occurred to you or your parents:

- Divorce
- Loss of job

